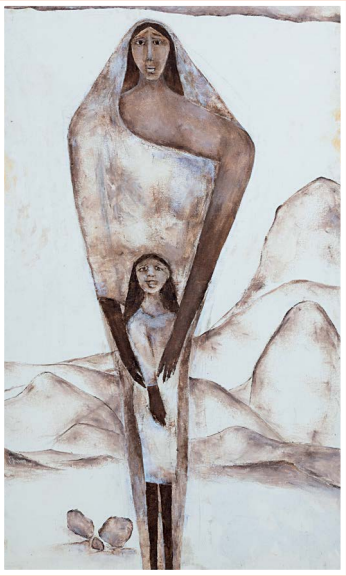
It is quite unusual to come across an exhibition where the gallery and the work itself arrive at a kind of tandem, as though it were custom-made for the contours of that specific space. But that's exactly what Anita Dube has achieved with her latest solo exhibition, *Three Storey House,* at Delhi's Vadehra Art Gallery (on till April 19). The gallery's three-floored building is the perfect conduit for Dube's vision. The top floor consists of abstract works (fabric, glue and plywood) she made during the pandemic and they evoke that sense of alienation that so many of us shared at the time. As we move down, each level takes on a different tone and form.

"Because this was my first solo exhibition in a while," Dube recalls, "there were suggestions that I could maybe pick a bigger, more laterally spread-out venue, but I told them that this structure (Vadehra Gallery) was perfect for me because this exhibition is really three bodies of work in one. As an artist, you don't want to be boxed into categories, like I don't want to be seen as only a political artist. If you decided to become an artist, at some level you want freedom, whether from societal constraints or familial ones."

The middle floor moves on to truisms and quotes by the likes of B.R. Ambedkar and Nelson Mandela. In 'After Dr Ambedkar' (velvet, cloth, thread, embroidery, wood, 67.25 x 56 inches), the words "Educate Agitate Organize" are emblazoned on a blue-green backdrop. As Dube explains, these can be seen as an effort to create "new flags" for popular, historically important resistance movements. "While I'm not a party member, I have always been connected with the Left," says Dube. "I feel like our resistance movements are impoverished because we don't have languages that are full of joy and full of hope.



**CRIMSON, OCHRE AND VIOLET**
An untitled work (fabric, glue and plywood, 2023) by Anita Dube on display at Vadehra Art Gallery





**THEMES FOR A MASTER**
Left, 'Mother and Child' (oil on canvas, 2009) and 'Jekare Angane Naurangiya' (oil on canvas, 2002) by Haku Shah

ART

# RICH LEGACIES

**A new art gallery in Mumbai aims to complete the narrative of South Asian art history, kicking off with a selection of Haku Shah's works**

In Mumbai's Fort district—home to many art galleries—Subcontinent is a new entrant dedicated to exploring South Asia's imprint on visual and material culture. Founded by Dhwani Gudka and Keshav Mahendru, it is designed as a space of inquiry for exploring the artistic identities of the region. "We started Subcontinent because of our deep engagement with the art, culture and archaeology of our region. Apart from exhibitions, we want to have archival material and different mediums